



KNOW HOW



❶ How do I add new TTF fonts in KDE?

—Maurice Pacheco,
Mangalore

To add new fonts, open the Conqueror file manager (or Dolphin, if you're using KDE4) and enter `fonts:/` in your location bar. The file manager will display two folders, namely Personal and System. If you want these fonts to be available to all system users, then copy your fonts to the System folder, otherwise to the Personal folder.

❶ I have a system in which openSUSE 10.3 is installed. It was working fine for two months, but now it lands only in verbose mode when booting the PC, and then asks me to repair the filesystem. Please tell me how I can solve this problem without reinstalling the system.

—Ananthakumar, akr_linux@rediffmail.com

The simplest way is to repair your system using the repair mode from the openSUSE 10.3 install DVD. Boot from the DVD and find out the options.

❶ I have installed openSUSE 11.1 from the DVD bundled with *LINUX For You* magazine. The installation was flawless on my new Compaq Presario V5000 laptop. It has a Celeron processor with 1 GB of RAM. After installation, both mouse and keyboard were working fine but now I have noticed that the double quotes key has got interchanged with the 'at the rate' (@) key. I also have Windows installed on my system and the keys are working fine there. What could be the problem?

—Neelabh Anand, Patna

It seems that you have selected the wrong keyboard type during installation (most probably the *English UK* keyboard). Launch the YaST administration and select *Keyboard Layout* from the *Hardware* section and set *Layout* to *English US*. Click OK and restart your X server to make the changes take place.

❶ The anniversary issue (February 2009) of LFY that carried the article on Richard Stallman impressed me very much. I have started reading about him and recently visited his homepage. After reading about his various principles, I have been inspired to change. I have removed MS Windows XP from my system and have resolved not to use proprietary software. I am planning to install ReactOS, an open source clone of Windows. But I don't know whether it is a complete OS. (Can it be installed on

computers?) The reason I'm asking this is that the file size of ReactOS is a mere 32 MB. Can I install any software that came with free software for Windows DVD (in November 2008) in it?

I'm interested in ReactOS because, although I have Kubuntu and OpenSolaris in my system, I don't find them easy to work on after having used Windows for so long. For example, Kubuntu doesn't have a media player to play MP3 files and others. This is the real reason why many people don't switch to GNU/Linux, I guess.

—Ramasubramanian
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Wow! It's great to read that you've dumped Windows for good. The idea is to depend (if at all) on proprietary software as little as possible.

MP3s do not work out-of-the-box in some GNU/Linux systems not due to their inability to play these media files, but because these codecs and plug-ins are not available out-of-the-box due to some patent and licensing restrictions that are applicable in some parts of the world. You can certainly enable these features by downloading the appropriate codecs and plug-ins from the Ubuntu repository. Take a look at help.ubuntu.com/community/RestrictedFormats for details. As for ReactOS, it's still in the alpha testing stage. It's okay if you'd like to test the OS, but we wouldn't recommend that you bet on an alpha-quality OS for everyday use. But, of course, please do give it a try, and see how it fares. 